

1 / 5 | Ages 9-12 | 20 minutes

Plan a small shared event

What we are practising

Allocate time, include a buffer and explain a scheduling choice.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Draw time blocks rather than a written timetable.

Before you begin

An imaginary event runs 4:00-4:45 and needs 5 minutes welcome, 25 activity and 10 cleanup.

The event is fictional; actual gatherings and responsibilities remain adult decisions.

Try it together

1. Add the required durations and find the time left over.
2. Place the tasks in a sensible order and include the spare time as a buffer.
3. Write start and end times for every block.
4. Imagine the activity starts three minutes late and adjust without finishing after 4:45.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Why might a plan with every minute already occupied be harder to follow?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 9-12 | 20 minutes

Compare choices with criteria

What we are practising

Compare options consistently and explain a reasoned decision.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Discuss a simple two-column list aloud.

Before you begin

Compare a drawing session, story circle and construction challenge for an imaginary group.

Do not assume anyone's needs; in real groups ask participants or the responsible adult.

Try it together

1. Choose three criteria, such as setup time, materials and ways everyone can participate.
2. For each activity, write one advantage and one limitation using the same criteria.
3. Agree which criterion matters most in this scenario.
4. Make a choice and explain what new information could change it.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Would a different group's needs lead to a different good choice?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 9-12 | 20 minutes

Repair a crossed message

What we are practising

Separate the words received from assumptions about the sender's intention.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Role-play the exchange aloud without a device.

Before you begin

Use a fictional message: Fine. Do it yourself.

Use fictional messages only; children should ask a trusted adult for help with threatening or upsetting real messages.

Try it together

1. List two possible interpretations without deciding which is true.
2. Write a neutral clarification, such as Do you mean I should finish alone, or shall we discuss it later?
3. Have a partner choose an intended meaning and answer.
4. Rewrite the original message so that meaning is clearer.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What information is missing when we see only a short written message?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 9-12 | 30 minutes

Teach a skill in five steps

What we are practising

Break a familiar skill into ordered steps with a clear check for success.

What you need

Paper / Pencil / Materials for a safe paper-folding task

Teach drawing a simple shape pattern instead of folding.

Before you begin

Choose a safe skill you know, such as folding a standing paper name card.

Choose safe paper tasks only; do not teach tool use, cooking or physical skills without suitable adult supervision.

Try it together

1. Perform the task slowly and identify up to five main steps.
2. Write each step with an action verb and add a sketch if useful.
3. Ask a partner to follow the guide while you observe without immediately correcting.
4. Revise the point where they paused, then include a final success check.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What did you know automatically that a beginner needed you to explain?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 9-12 | 20 minutes

Share less, explain why

What we are practising

Match shared information to an audience and purpose.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use a spoken imaginary invitation and list edits aloud.

Before you begin

Imagine a private family drawing session announced on a public noticeboard with a child's full name, home address and daily routine.

Do not write real personal data, contact strangers or publish the practice invitation; adults decide actual sharing.

Try it together

1. Identify who needs the invitation and who can see the noticeboard.
2. Mark which details are unnecessary for the public audience.
3. Rewrite the notice without names, addresses or routines, directing interested adults to a responsible adult privately.
4. Explain why a private family plan may be better shared directly with invited adults.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Does useful information for one invited person belong on a public board?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Plan a small shared event

A little hint

Required tasks total 40 minutes, leaving 5 minutes free.

Answer / what to notice

One plan: welcome 4:00-4:05, activity 4:05-4:30, buffer 4:30-4:35, cleanup 4:35-4:45.

The five-minute buffer can absorb a three-minute delay while preserving all required durations and the finish time.

Make it easier

Place three prepared time blocks on a timeline.

Take it further

Add a second activity and decide what to shorten, explaining the tradeoff.

Another day, away from the screen

Estimate and then observe the duration of one familiar household task.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Compare choices with criteria

A little hint

Distinguish a known requirement from a guessed preference.

Answer / what to notice

Any option can be reasonable if it fits the stated priorities; there is no universal winner.

Criteria make comparisons explicit, while different priorities can legitimately change the result.

Make it easier

Compare only two activities against one clear need.

Take it further

Weight one criterion twice as heavily and examine whether the decision changes.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the same comparison method for two ways to organize a pretend bookshelf.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Repair a crossed message

A little hint

Tone, timing and context may be missing; do not label one guess as a fact.

Answer / what to notice

A useful response asks about the task or intention without insulting or claiming to know the person's feelings.

Clarification can check meaning before a mistaken assumption shapes the next reply.

Make it easier

Choose between two prepared clarification questions.

Take it further

Write versions for a friend and a formal group task while keeping both respectful.

Another day, away from the screen

Collect three neutral phrases for checking meaning, such as Could you explain which part?

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Teach a skill in five steps

A little hint

For a fold, specify which edges meet and whether the paper starts flat.

Answer / what to notice

A strong guide lets the learner complete the task and recognize the result; revisions should address observed confusion.

Teaching exposes hidden steps and assumptions in a familiar process.

Make it easier

Give three picture steps with an adult's help.

Take it further

Create a version for someone using only one hand, then ask whether the adaptation is workable.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap guides and give one specific helpful suggestion each.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Share less, explain why

A little hint

Think about the smallest audience that actually needs each detail.

Answer / what to notice

A reasonable revision removes personal details and uses an adult-managed private invitation; publishing nothing publicly is also valid.

Audience and purpose determine what needs sharing; extra personal details can travel beyond the intended recipients.

Make it easier

Sort fictional details into needed for the invitation and not needed.

Take it further

Compare what belongs in a public announcement, a private invitation and no message at all.

Another day, away from the screen

Create a three-question check: who needs this, why, and can I share less?